

STAGE ELEVEN • TOOLS & TECHNOLOGY

FIRSTS

GROUP VERSIONS OF KEY EXERCISES

Live, group-adapted versions of the FIRSTS that benefit most from interaction

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Group Versions of Key Exercises

Stage Eleven • Tools & Technology

PURPOSE

Stage Eleven's Templates workbook is written for solo, hands-on practice with real tools. But tool fluency, more than most skills in this program, benefits from watching someone else's screen, comparing outputs side by side, and teaching a feature you just learned. This document adapts seven FIRSTS across all three sections into pair, small-group, or peer-teaching formats.

As with every stage, these are additions, not replacements — participants complete their own individual hands-on practice first, and the group version deepens or stress-tests it. Given how device-dependent this stage already is, several of these adaptations lean on peer teaching specifically, since explaining a feature you just learned is one of the fastest ways to confirm you've actually learned it.

The Seven Adapted Exercises

FIRST O1

Tool Ecosystem Awareness — Category Relay

TIME: +15 min beyond solo mapping

1. Small groups of 3–4, each assigned a different tool category (communication, project management, data, design).
2. Each group has 3 minutes to list every tool they can think of in their assigned category, real or half-remembered names are fine.
3. Groups rotate to a new category's list and add anything the previous group missed.
4. Full group reviews the final combined lists together.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Pooling multiple people's partial knowledge produces a far more complete map than any one person's individual awareness — exactly the point of this FIRST.

FIRST O5

Spreadsheet Tool Mastery — Function Swap Challenge

TIME: +15 min beyond solo practice

1. Pairs. Each person picks one advanced function they don't already know well from a short facilitator-provided list (VLOOKUP, pivot tables, conditional formatting, etc.).
2. Each person has 5 minutes to learn their function well enough to explain and demonstrate it.
3. Partners teach each other their function, then each tries the other's function on a sample dataset.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Teaching a function immediately after learning it forces genuine understanding rather than passive exposure, and pairs leave with two new skills instead of one.

FIRST O16

Git & GitHub Exposure — Pair Programming Lite

TIME: +10 min beyond solo attempt

1. Pair a participant with some prior Git exposure with one who has none, where possible.
2. The more experienced partner narrates each step while the newer partner drives (types the actual commands).
3. Swap roles for a second, different basic action if time allows.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Git's command-line interface is genuinely intimidating for first-timers; having a peer narrate in plain language while the newcomer's hands do the typing builds real confidence faster than solo trial and error.

FIRST O17

AI Tool Exploration — Prompt Battle

TIME: +15 min beyond solo use

1. Small groups. Everyone gives the same AI tool the same real, genuine task (e.g., “summarize this paragraph” using a shared sample text).
2. Compare outputs across the group: what varied based on how each person phrased their prompt?
3. Discuss: what made the strongest output stronger than the others?

FACILITATOR NOTE

Seeing how differently the same tool responds to different phrasing, side by side, teaches real prompting skill faster than any explanation could on its own.

FIRST O22

Automation Tool Exploration — Repetitive Task Swap

TIME: +15 min beyond solo identification

1. Each person writes their identified repetitive task on a card or shared doc, without their name attached.
2. Shuffle and redistribute so each person gets someone else's task.
3. In pairs, discuss: would you have identified this as automatable? What tool or approach comes to mind?

FACILITATOR NOTE

An outside perspective often spots a genuinely viable automation approach that the original person, too close to their own routine, hadn't considered.

FIRST O25

Tool Comparison Exercise — Debate Round

TIME: +20 min beyond solo research

1. Small groups, each researching two real alternative tools for the same use case (e.g., two project management tools, two note-taking apps).
2. Split the group in half: each half argues for one of the two tools, using genuine features and trade-offs, not just preference.
3. After both sides present, the group votes on which tool they'd genuinely choose, and why.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Being assigned a side to argue for, rather than just stating a personal preference, forces genuine research into a tool's real strengths, even ones a participant wouldn't have personally chosen.

FIRST O27

Software Troubleshooting Exercise — Troubleshooting Relay

TIME: +15 min beyond solo practice

1. Facilitator prepares 3–4 common, genuine software issues on cards (frozen application, can't find a saved file, a formatting error that won't clear).
2. Small groups rotate through each card, with 3 minutes to propose a specific troubleshooting step before moving to the next.
3. Facilitator reveals what each issue's most likely real fix actually is.

FACILITATOR NOTE

Practicing a genuine troubleshooting sequence (check settings, search the exact error message, restart) on low-stakes example problems builds the habit before a real, higher-stakes issue arises.